

HANDBOOK LABOR

*Exhibit solutions toolkit*¹

LABOR is a multidisciplinary design laboratory operating across design, experimentation and visual culture.

LABOR supports exhibition projects requiring **adaptable** and **self-sufficient systems** focusing on **process reduction**.

Within a **sustainability-oriented** approach, the laboratory prioritizes material reuse, local resources and the adaptation of existing products and systems.

¹ A focus on systems, constraints and construction logics.
Artworks appear only as contextual elements within technical documentation.

Clients

Artists and institutions

Lukas Hoffmann

Armin Linke

Nora Mertes

Martina Pozzan

Centre national d'art et de culture Georges-Pompidou, Paris, FRA

Comune di Cheremule, Sassari, ITA

Galerie im Körnerpark - Fachbereich Kultur Neukölln, Berlin, DEU

IGFAE - Instituto Galego de Fisica de Atlas Enerxias, Santiago, ESP

Innsitu - BTV Stadtforum, Innsbruck, AUT

K.H.I. Kunsthistorisches Institut in Florenz, Florence, ITA

Museum Neukölln, Berlin, DEU

Saarländische Galerie - Europäisches Kunstforum E.V., Berlin, DEU

Areas of focus

Heritage preservation - A

Context Protected historic buildings
Strategy Non-invasive, reversible solutions
Response Temporary supports that preserve both object and architecture

Reversibility - B

Context Need of flexible solutions suitable for reconfiguration and reuse
Strategy Simplified design of adaptable systems
Response Systems designed to be undone and reshaped

No frame - C

Context Image-centered exhibitions
Strategy Minimal design
Response Reduction of visual mediation

Free-standing - D

Context Lack of load-bearing or fixable architectural supports
Strategy Self-supporting systems operating independently from the environment
Response Stability through geometry, mass distribution or counterweights

Infrastructure reuse - E

Context Pre-existing technical or architectural systems
Strategy Activation of the existing environment as an integral part of the exhibition system
Response Reinterpretation of secondary infrastructures as load-bearing devices

Standardization - F

Context Budget constraints, material accessibility
Strategy Open-source design and self-production
Response Reconfiguration of standard components available in consumer supply chain

Modularity and portability - G

Context Reduced-staff installations requiring a straightforward, universal setup
Strategy Design of pre-assembled systems
Response Lightweight, modular, demountable and small dimension components

Unconventional contexts - H

Context Non-exhibition spaces and hybrid environments
Strategy Adaptation to existing spatial constraints
Response Custom systems responding to irregular conditions

Floating - I

Context Need for visual lightness and detachment
Strategy Simplification and concealment of the load-bearing structures
Response Load transfer managed through tension, compression, or hybrid systems

Space construction - L

Context Exhibit elements operating at an architectural scale
Strategy Structures that generate paths, thresholds, or rooms
Response Objects conceived as spatial devices

References

18.20_022-001

<i>Context</i>	Film set in a natural landscape
<i>Typology</i>	Large-scale modular scenographic elements
<i>System</i>	Ground-based, tension-stabilized structures
<i>Purpose</i>	Hosting a performance
<i>Key aspects</i>	Portability, lightweight structures, temporary anchoring, environmental preservation

4.19_025-001/2/4

<i>Context</i>	Exhibition in an historic building with archival infrastructure
<i>Typology</i>	Adaptive hanging system
<i>System</i>	Compression and cantilever system
<i>Application</i>	Exhibiting framed artworks
<i>Key aspects</i>	Infrastructure reuse, floating display, precision adjustment, no wall intervention

4.19_024-001-01

<i>Context</i>	Archival/editorial exhibition
<i>Typology</i>	Minimal display for paper-based content
<i>System</i>	Inclined glass panels on light brackets
<i>Application</i>	Exhibiting works on paper
<i>Key aspects</i>	Material reduction, reversibility, image autonomy, visual lightness

4.19_024-002

<i>Context</i>	Exhibition in an historic church
<i>Typology</i>	Non invasive suspension system
<i>System</i>	Compression and tension-based system
<i>Application</i>	Exhibiting framed artworks
<i>Key aspects</i>	Non-invasive setup, floating effect, heritage preservation, adjustability

4.19_023-002

<i>Context</i>	Exhibition in a contemporary art gallery
<i>Typology</i>	Exhibition totems
<i>System</i>	Self-standing steel profiles frame
<i>Application</i>	Exhibiting images, objects, mixed media
<i>Key aspects</i>	Modularity, standardization, infrastructure-free, reconfigurability

4.19_023-001

<i>Context</i>	Museum exhibition
<i>Typology</i>	Image displays
<i>System</i>	Leaning elements, no wall fixing
<i>Application</i>	Exhibiting images on DiBond
<i>Key aspects</i>	Reversibility, preservation, no-frame, space construction

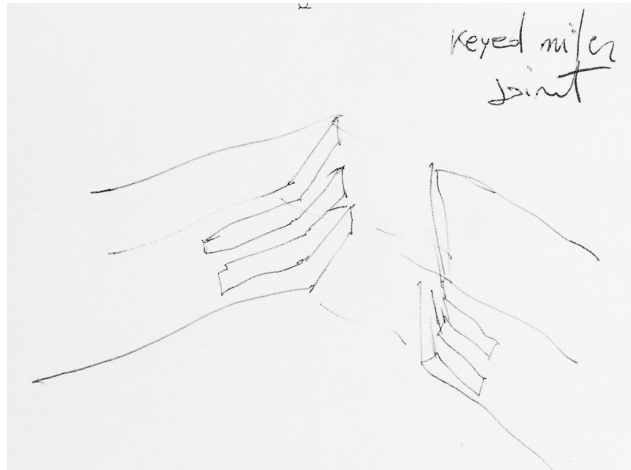
4.19_026-001

<i>Context</i>	Workspace
<i>Typology</i>	Wooden table structure
<i>System</i>	Self-supporting braced frame
<i>Application</i>	Versatile
<i>Key aspects</i>	Self-produced, adaptability, standardization, reversibility, reuse, rapid implementation

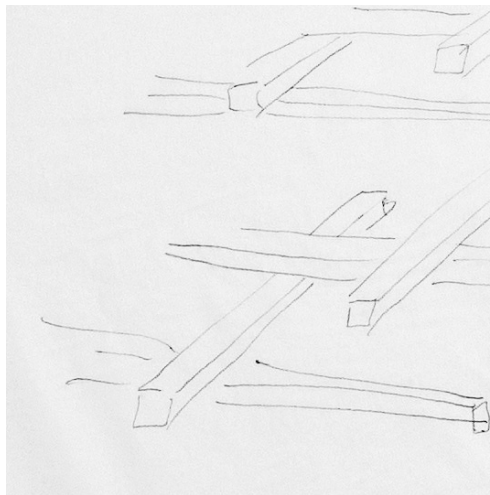
Atlas
cross reference table

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Schematics



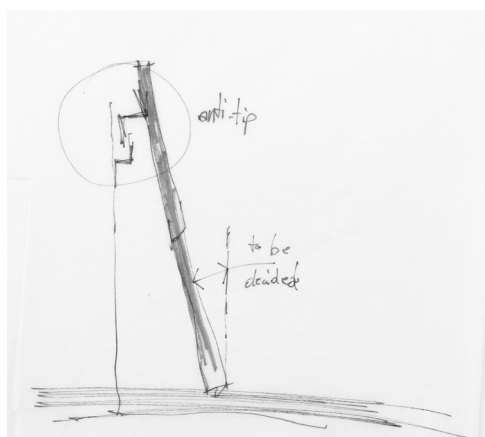
Keyed miter joint



Butt joint



Framework



Anti-tip device

Large-scale spatial elements
composed of **lightweight modular
wooden portals**.
Structures are assembled without
hardware and stabilized through
non-invasive ground anchoring. All
components are designed for **manual
transport and rapid deployment**.
Despite their slenderness, the
system ensures **structural stability
in outdoor conditions**.

Object Temporary scenography for a short movie
Folders A, B, F, G, H, L

Context Outdoor archaeological site, environmental restrictions, uneven ground
Requirement Climate factors resistance, transportability and easy/fast assembly
Protection constraints No drill on stones, no excavation on ground

Structural principle Piers and architrave with tongue and groove joints
Ground contact strategy Point support and slight pegs anchoring
Stability control Nylon strings set, normal tension
Load transfer method Gravity load

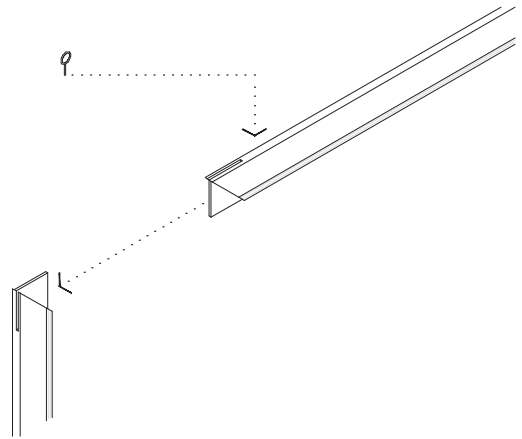
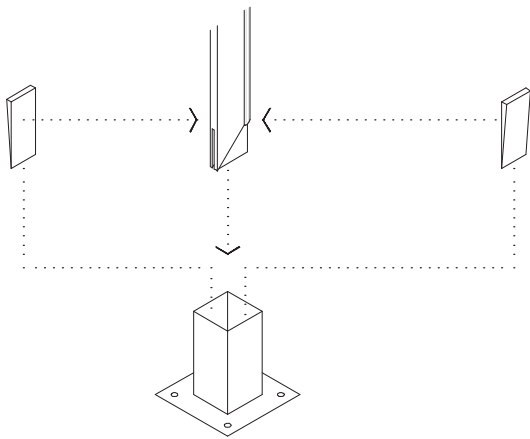
Materials Pine wood, nylon, metal
Standard components used Canvas frame profiles, nylon strings, metal post brackets
Availability of components Very high
Assembly/disassembly process Dry assembly with manual tools
Reversibility of the process 100%

Hosted performance Dance
Support system Vertical posts
Interface support/structure Metal post brackets
Adjustment devices Wooden wedges to adjust portal height and vertical
Supporting structure Ground

Transport / Handling Car roof / hand handling
Smallest divisible unit 0,9 to 3m lenght
Max. dimension 5 x 3m (biggest portal)

Notes

Assembly



Installation view



Exhibition system **integrated** within an **existing archival shelving infrastructure**.

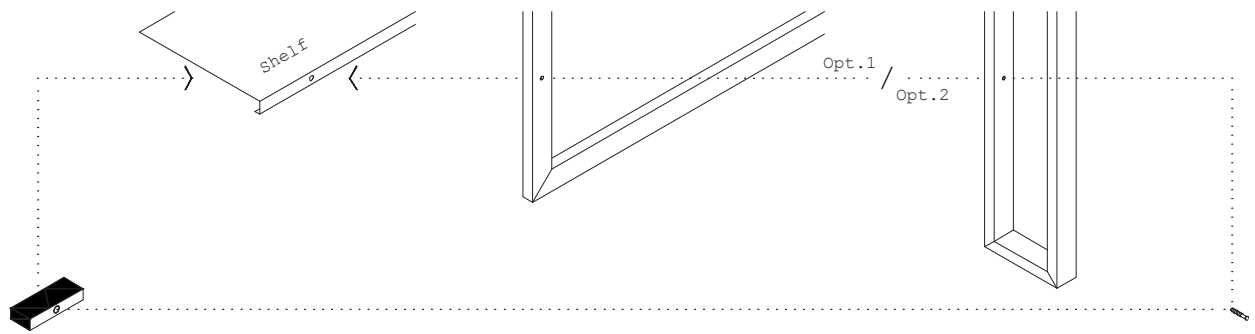
Custom interfaces transform secondary structures into **load-bearing supports** for suspended works.

The system allows **fine adjustment** during installation, ensuring alignment and balance.

Additional elements create **controlled spatial distancing** between artworks and supports.

Object	Adaptive hanging system for exhibition
Folders	E, H, I
Context	Historic building, former archive
Requirement	Flexible shelving anchoring
Protection constraints	No drill on walls/floor, no leaning on walls
Structural principle	Through-bolt connection with threaded inserts and compression-lock
Ground contact strategy	-
Stability control	Self-stabilizing system
Load transfer method	Friction and compression, bearing stress, clamping effect
Materials	Painted maple wood
Standard components used	-
Availability of components	High
Assembly/disassembly process	Dry assembly with manual tools
Reversibility of the process	100%
Exhibited artwork	Framed image
Frame support system	Wooden back-frame
Interface support/structure	Through-bolt assembly with internal threaded anchorage (Clamping Connection System)
Adjustment devices	Slotted hole
Supporting structure	Metal shelves
Transport / Handling	Cargo bike, car / hand handling
Smallest divisible unit	50 x 60cm, 50 x 15cm
Max. dimension	-
Notes	

Assembly



Installation views



Minimal display device designed to present archival material as **temporary, non-monumental objects**.

Printed sheets are held between glass surfaces supported by simple **wooden brackets**.

The absence of frames reinforces a **non-permanent exhibition logic**.

Elements rely on compression and gravity, ensuring **reversibility and ease of removal**.

Object Wooden structure display for paper artwork
Folders B, C, I

Context Exhibition
Requirement Minimal design without frame
Protection constraints Archival standards

Structural principle L-brackets, cantilever beam
Ground contact strategy -
Stability control L-brackets jointed with keyed miter
Load transfer method Tensile stress(upper connection), compressive stress(lower connection)

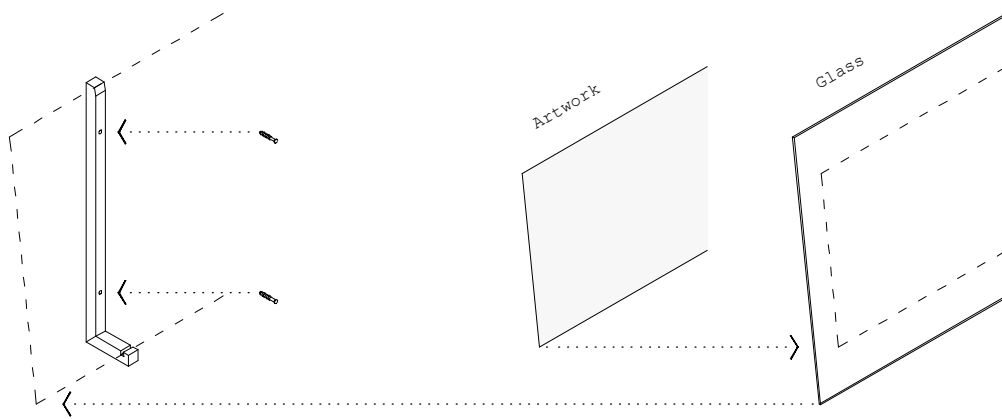
Materials Maple wood, glass AR70
Standard components used -
Availability of components High
Assembly/disassembly process Dry assembly with power tools
Reversibility of the process 100%

Exhibited artwork Works on paper
Paper **support system** Paper taped on glass sheet standing on L-brackets
Interface support/structure Brackets drilled on wall
Adjustment devices Slotted hole on brackets
Supporting structure Wall

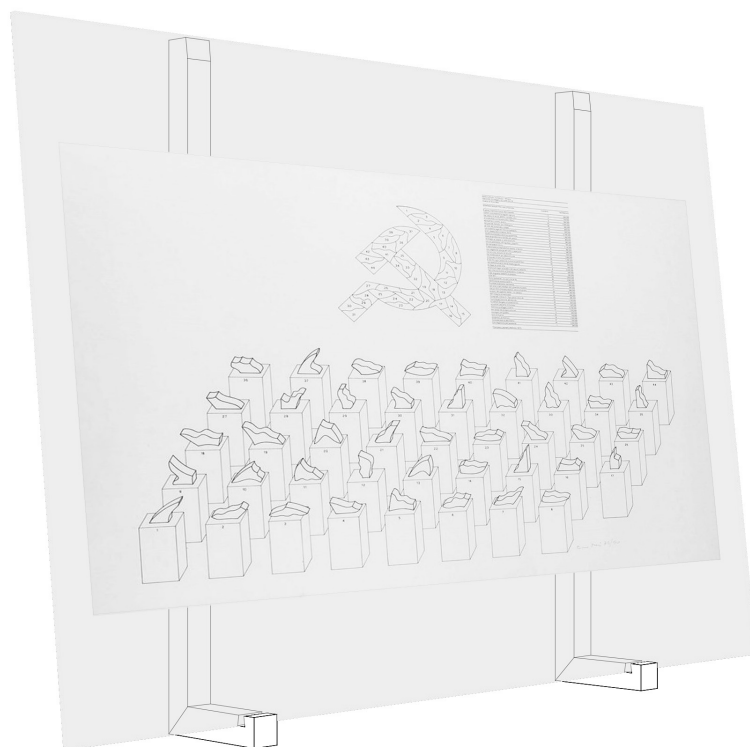
Transport / Handling Car / hand handling
Single element max. size 47 x 9cm, 69 x 46cm
Max. dimension(assembled) 69 x 47 x 9cm

Notes

Assembly



Axonometric projection



4.19_024-002

Instruments of vision

Suspended display system developed for a **historic architectural context** with no physical alteration. Light wooden frames are secured using **tensioned straps**, distributing load without surface damage. Frames enable **free positioning** in space, including corners and vertical elements. The system creates the perception of **floating images** while preserving structural integrity.

Object Hanging system for frames
Folders A, B, H, I

Context Historic church
Requirement Non-invasive pillar anchoring
Protection constraints No drill, no glue on walls and pillars

Structural principle Tensioned ratchet band clamp
Ground contact strategy -
Stability control Tension control
Load transfer method Compressed (to the pillar) back-frame trough tensioned straps

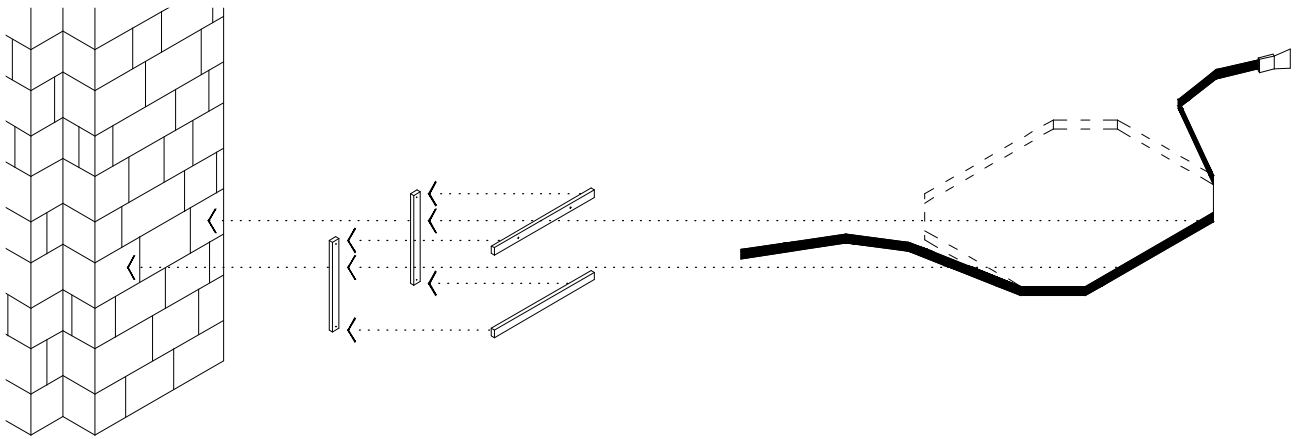
Materials Beech wood, polypropylene
Standard components used Endless ratchet straps
Availability of components Very high
Assembly/disassembly process Dry assembly with manual tools
Reversibility of the process 100%

Exhibited artwork Framed image
Frame **support system** Wooden back-frame
Interface support/structure Endless ratchet strap
Adjustment devices Built-in feature
Supporting structure Stone pillars

Transport / Handling Cargo bike, car / hand handling
Single element max. size 60 x 4cm, 20 x 20cm
Max. dimension(assembled) 50 x 60cm (back-frame)

Notes

Assembly



Installation view

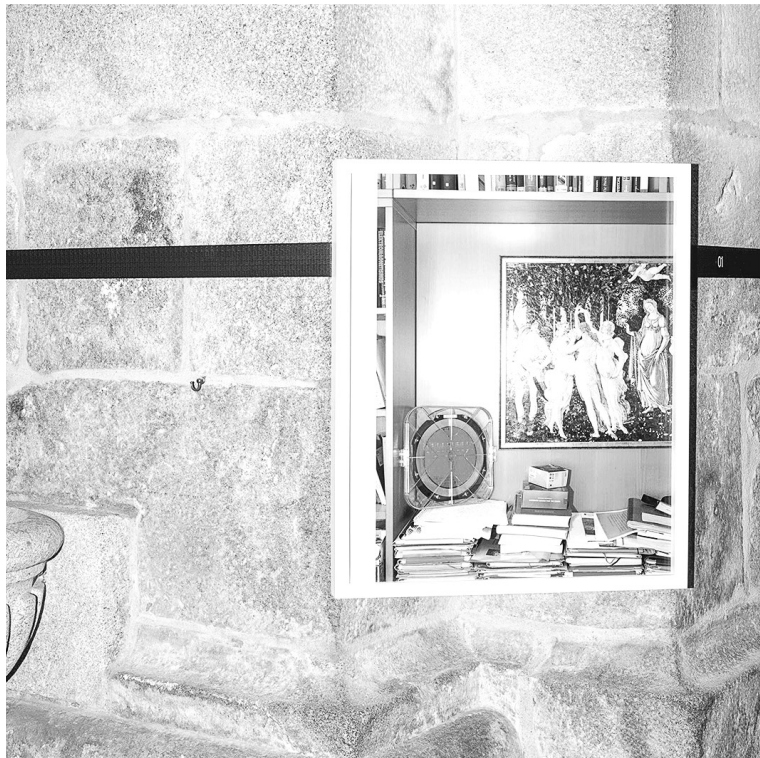


Photo: Armin Linke

4.19_023-002

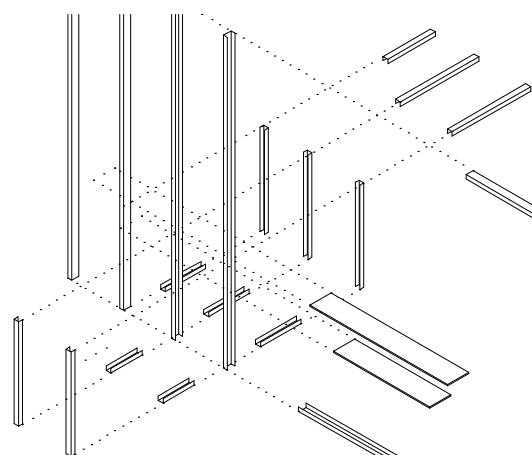
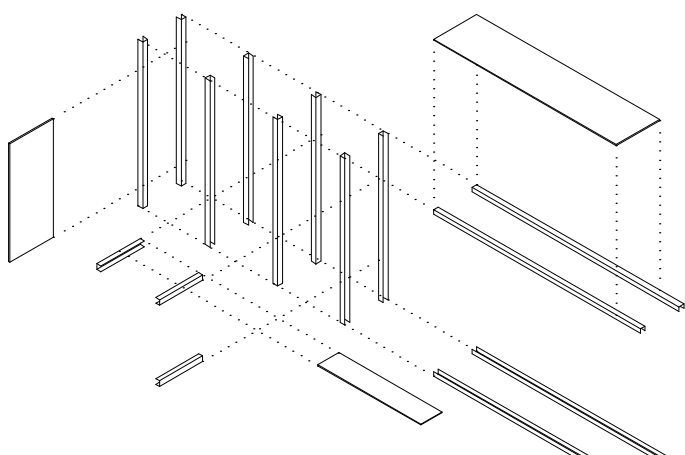
Greifen und Loslassen

Spatial support structures built from **standard drywall steel profiles**, left exposed and untreated. Elements function as **self-standing three-dimensional supports**, adaptable to multiple layouts. The system allows **direct intervention** on surfaces while remaining fully demountable. Components can be repositioned, reused, or reconfigured without fixed anchoring.

Object	Modular spatial totems
Folders	B, D, F, G, L
Context	Exhibition space
Requirement	Free-standing, modularity and portability, standardization
Protection constraints	No drill on ground
Structural principle	Self-supporting braced frame
Ground contact strategy	Single/Dual linear support
Stability control	Contact area configuration
Load transfer method	Gravity load
Materials	Galvanized steel, MDF
Standard components used	Drywall Framing: U-Track, C-Stud
Availability of components	Very high
Assembly/disassembly process	Dry assembly with power tools
Reversibility of the process	100%
Exhibited artwork	Variable (framed artworks, works on paper, etc)
Support system	Totem
Structural connections	Double-bolt interlocking joint with moment-resisting coupling
Adjustment devices	-
Supporting structure	Floor
Transport / Handling	L2-3 Van / hand handling
Single element max. size	1,5 to 3 m lenght
Max. dimension(assembled)	215 x 150 x 45m, 165 x 300 x 80m

Notes

Structural elements



Installation view



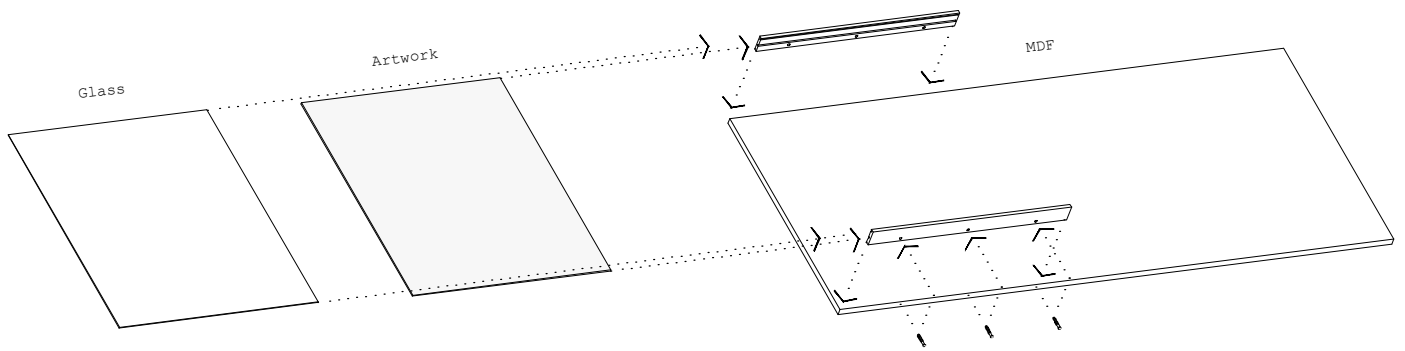
Photo: Martina Pozzan

Freestanding display system based on **inclined wooden panels** resting against existing walls. Images are inserted through **minimal lateral profiles**, allowing tool-free installation and replacement. No wall perforation is required, the system relies on **controlled leaning and gravity**. Museum-grade glazing ensures **museum conservation standards** while maintaining visual lightness.

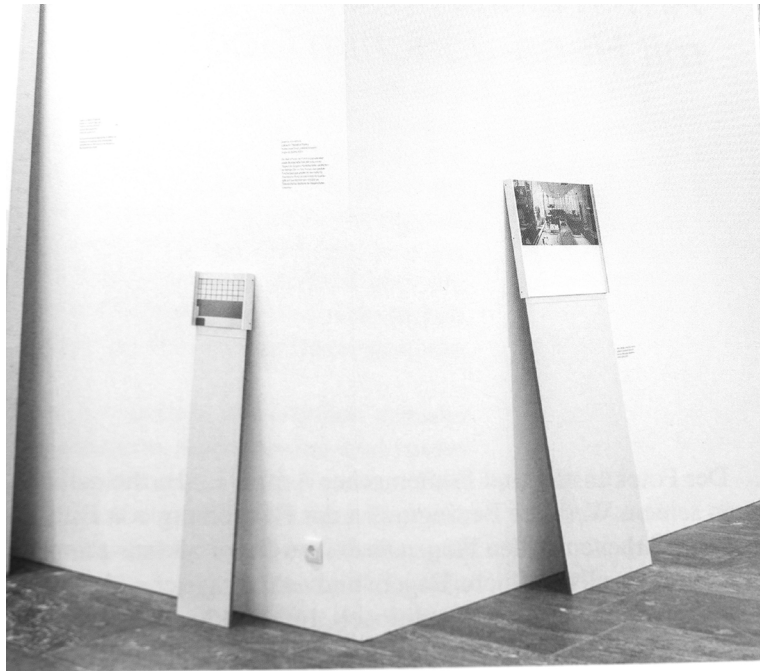
Object	Leaning display system
Folders	B, C, I
Context	Exhibition space
Requirement	Unconstrained placement along the walls
Protection constraints	-
Structural principle	Gravity-based leaning panel
Ground contact strategy	Linear support
Stability control	Rear anti-tip bracket
Load transfer method	Gravity load, lateral thrust
Materials	MDF, maple wood, glass AR70
Standard components used	-
Availability of components	High
Assembly/disassembly process	Dry assembly with power tools
Reversibility of the process	100%
Exhibited artwork	Images mounted on DiBond
Image support system	Side Support Rails for Dibond/glass with built-in end stops
Interface support/structure	Rails screwed to the MDF panel
Adjustment devices	-
Supporting structure	Wall/floor
Transport / Handling	L2 Van / hand handling
Single element max. size	140 x 25cm, 160 x 60cm
Max. dimension(assembled)	140 x 25 x 5cm, 160 x 60 x 5cm

Notes

Assembly



Installation view



A self-made workstation ready for use in **2 hours**, from the initial idea.

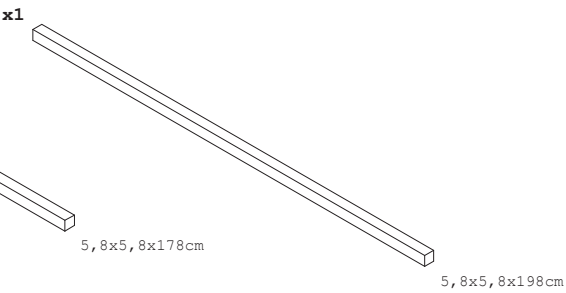
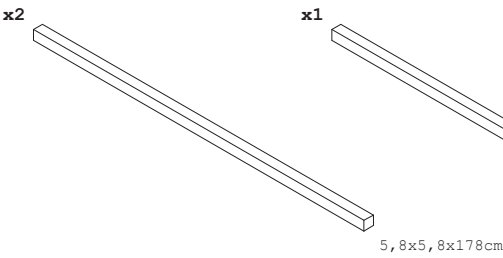
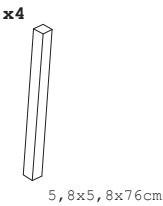
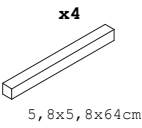
Self-supporting braced frame assembled from readily available timber profiles allows **non-prescriptive configurations** and supports **open-design and self-production**.

The open assembly logic enables reinterpretation, reversibility, and reuse across different exhibition requirements and other spatial uses.

Object	Wooden table structure
Folders	B, D, F, G, I
Context	Working/exhibition space
Requirement	Flexibility, cost-effectiveness, self-producibility, reconfigurability
Protection constraints	-
Structural principle	Braced frame structure with butt joints
Ground contact strategy	Static point load
Stability control	Bracing
Load transfer method	Gravity load
Materials	Pine timber
Standard components used	Wooden construction beams with standard profile
Availability of components	Very high
Assembly/disassembly process	Dry assembly with manual or power tools
Reversibility of the process	100%
Working surface	Wooden board
Board support	Wooden braced frame structure
Interface support/structure	-
Adjustment devices	-
Supporting structure	Floor
Transport / Handling	Car / hand handling
Single element max. size	ca. 200cm lenght
Max. dimension(assembled)	178 x 71 x 78cm

Notes

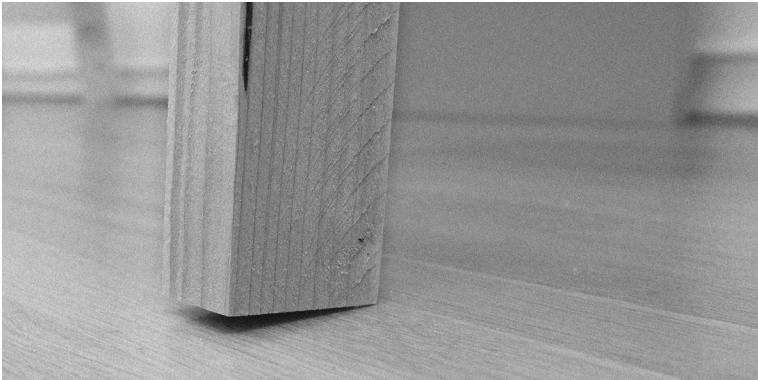
Schedule of components
Configuration#1 table 200x70



Structure



Corner bearing detail



Colophon

HANDBOOK LABOR – Exhibit solution toolkit

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LABOR is a project developed in collaboration between Martina Pozzan and Alberto Stievanin

Concept, design and production: LABOR

Texts and contents: LABOR

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References and context: the projects presented are derived from real applications developed in collaboration with cultural institutions, artists and independent spaces. References are intentionally anonymized to foreground constraints, structural logic and transferable principles, rather than specific events, authorship or commissions.

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